Progress Christian Centre

Connect Hub

Complete User Guide

Finance & Student Management Portal

Version 2026.05 • All Portals: Admin, Staff, Teacher, Student, Owner

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1. Getting Started & Login

Progress Christian Centre Connect Hub is the official finance and student management portal. It serves Administrators, Cashiers, Timetable Managers, Teachers, Students and the Owner from a single secure web app.

Accessing the System

- Open the portal URL in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Safari, Firefox).
- The login screen offers two modes: Student login (registration number) and Admin/Staff login (name selector).
- Sessions are kept secure; idle sessions are timed out automatically for sensitive areas.

Logging In

Students

- Enter your 6-character registration number (e.g. K0023T).
- Enter the password you created during account setup.
- Click Sign In to enter the Student Portal.

Staff / Admin

- Click 'Admin / Staff Login' on the login card.
- Select your name from the dropdown (list is fetched live from the server).
- Enter your password and sign in. You will be routed to your role's landing page.

If you forget your password, contact the system administrator. Passwords cannot be reset by students themselves for security reasons.

2. Account Setup (Students)

New students must claim their account before logging in. Registration numbers are pre-loaded by the school and mapped internally to a virtual email (REGNUMBER@pcc.local).

Claiming Your Account

- From the login page click 'Set up your account'.
- Enter your registration number exactly as issued by the school.
- Create a strong password (minimum 8 characters, mix of letters and numbers).
- Confirm the password and submit. You will be redirected to the login screen.
- Use your registration number + new password to sign in.

Each registration number can only be claimed once. If your number is already claimed and you did not do it, contact the administrator immediately.

3. Student Portal

Dashboard

On login, students see a personalised dashboard with quick links to Payments, Timetable, Courses, Announcements, Fees & Requirements and the School Shop.

Payments

- View all payments recorded against your account.
- See running balance, total paid and amount outstanding.
- Download / reprint your receipts (with QR verification code).
- Initiate online payments via EcoCash or Visa where enabled (Paynow Zimbabwe).

Timetable

View your personal class timetable, generated from the school's master timetable. Days, periods, subjects, teachers and rooms are listed clearly.

Courses / Subjects

See subjects assigned to your class/stream. For Forms 5-6 this reflects your Sciences, Commercials or Arts stream selection.

Announcements

Read messages from the school targeted at your role, class or the entire student body. New announcements are highlighted at the top.

Fees & Requirements

See the fees applicable to your form/stream, broken down by category (tuition, levies, uniform, books, etc.). Beginners and returning students may see different requirements as set by administration.

School Shop

Browse stationery, uniforms and other items available from the school. Items are linked to inventory and updated in real time.

4. Teacher Portal

Dashboard

Teachers land on a dashboard with quick cards for Mark Attendance, Class Roster and View Timetable.

Attendance

- Select the class and date.
- Mark each student as Present, Absent or Late.
- Save the register; entries are stored and reflected in admin reports.

Class Roster

View the full list of students in classes you teach, including registration numbers and stream.

Timetable

See your personal teaching timetable: day, period, subject, class and room. Synced with the master timetable.

Announcements

Read announcements targeted to teachers or the whole school.

5. Admin Portal Overview

The Admin Portal is the operational heart of the system. The sidebar exposes every module the signed-in role is allowed to access. Cashiers and Timetable Managers see reduced sidebars scoped to their duties.

Sidebar Modules

- Dashboard - metrics & charts
- Students - registration & profiles
- Payments - record, scan & verify
- Subjects, Teachers, Classes - academic structure

- Class Roster - student/class mapping
- Timetable & Master Timetable - scheduling
- Reports - exports & analytics
- Audit Trail - activity log
- Announcements - messaging & SMS
- Fees & Requirements - pricing
- Inventory - stock control
- Procurement - requisitions & GRN
- Settings - school configuration

6. Student Management

Adding Students

- Manual entry: fill the form with names, registration number, form, stream, gender and contact.
- AI OCR upload: take a photo of a printed class list; the system extracts students with names and reg numbers.
- Bulk import: paste or upload a list for batch creation.

Registration Numbers

Reg numbers are 6 characters (e.g. K0023T). They are unique and used for login. The system protects against duplicates.

Editing & Deactivating

- Edit any field directly from the student row.
- Upload or replace the student photo (used on the printable ID card).
- Deactivate (rather than delete) students who leave, preserving history.

Student ID Cards

Generate ISO ID-1 sized cards individually or in bulk. Cards include photo, name, registration number, class and a QR code. Photos are stored in the secure 'student-photos' bucket.

7. Payments & Receipts

Recording a Payment

- Select the student (search by name or reg number).
- Enter amount, currency (USD / ZWL / ZAR), method and reference.
- Optionally attach a scan of the bank slip or EcoCash SMS.
- Save - a receipt is generated automatically with a QR code that links to /verify.

Payment Scanning (OCR)

Use the AI Extract feature to scan a bank slip or EcoCash confirmation. The system reads amount, reference and date. If the payer is unknown, an inline 'Quick Register' lets you create the student on the spot.

Bulk Payments

Upload a batch (e.g. an EcoCash statement) - the extract-payments-bulk function parses and lets you review/confirm before posting.

Receipts

- A4 or 80mm thermal printer formats.
- QR code prints on every receipt; scanning routes to a public /verify page that confirms authenticity.
- Reprint at any time from the payment row.

Online Payments

Paynow Zimbabwe integration enables EcoCash and Visa payments initiated from the Student Portal. Successful payments are written back to the student's ledger automatically.

Fees Status by Class

On the Payments page, the 'Fees Status by Class' section groups every student by class and shows who has paid and who has not. Click 'Fees by Class PDF' to export a printable A4 report with paid amounts and outstanding lists per class.

8. Fees & Requirements

Configure the fee structure for each Form and Stream. The system distinguishes between Beginner and Returning students so first-year items (uniform, prospectus, etc.) appear only where appropriate.

- Define categories: tuition, development levy, uniform, books, exams, boarding, etc.
- Set prices per Form (1-4: G1, G2, G22, Blue) and per Stream (Forms 5-6: Sciences, Commercials, Arts).
- Students automatically see their applicable requirements in their portal.
- Totals roll up into expected fees on the Payments dashboard.

9. Subjects, Teachers & Classes

Subjects

Create subjects with code, name and applicable forms. Subjects feed into the timetable generator and the student course list.

Teachers

Manage teaching staff: name, subjects taught, classes taught, contact. Teachers with portal access are linked to a login account.

Classes

Define classes by Form and Stream. Forms 1-4 use streams G1, G2, G22, Blue. Forms 5-6 use Sciences, Commercials, Arts.

10. Class Roster & Attendance

The Class Roster maps students to classes. From here, admins can move students between classes, print rosters and view headcounts.

Attendance is captured by teachers in the Teacher Portal and is visible to admins in reports. Attendance percentages appear on the dashboard.

11. Timetable & Master Timetable

Generate Timetable

The AI-assisted generator builds a draft timetable from subjects, teachers, rooms and class loads. Conflicts are flagged before publishing.

Master Timetable

- Centralised view of every class and teacher across the week.
- Edit a slot in place; changes propagate to student and teacher views instantly.
- Export to A3 landscape PDF for staff-room printing.
- Backup and restore via the Timetable Backup panel.

12. Announcements & Notifications

Announcements can be targeted to specific roles (students, teachers, all), specific classes or the whole school. Each announcement may also trigger external notifications.

- SMS and WhatsApp via Pingram (Zimbabwe numbers prefixed +263).
- Custom message text supported per send.
- Delivery is logged for audit.

13. Inventory & School Shop

Track stock of stationery, uniforms, books and other goods.

- Add items with SKU, name, category, cost, sell price and stock level.
- Stock decrements automatically on shop sales / issuance.
- Low-stock items appear on the admin dashboard.
- Generate inventory receipts for issued goods.

14. Procurement (Requisitions & GRN)

Requisitions

- Create a requisition listing items, quantities and notes.
- Edit a requisition at any time - edited requisitions are labelled 'Edited'.
- Export to PDF for signatures.

Goods Received Notes (GRN)

- Open the GRN tab in Procurement (or sidebar link 'Goods Received').
- Capture supplier, date, items received, unit cost and total amount.
- Choose currency (USD / ZWL / ZAR).
- Upload one or more receipt/invoice scans as evidence (stored in the secure 'grn-receipts' bucket).
- Print the GRN as a PDF with unit prices and totals included.
- Deleting a GRN also removes its attached receipts from storage.

15. Reports & Audit Trail

Reports

Export PDF/CSV reports for payments, fees status, class lists, attendance, inventory and procurement. Dashboard charts use Recharts for live visualisations.

Audit Trail

Every significant action (login, login_failed, payment posted, student edited, GRN created, etc.) is recorded with user, timestamp and details. Use filters to investigate incidents.

16. Owner Dashboard

The Owner role sees a high-level overview of school finances, enrolment and operations. Access is read-only and designed for board-level visibility.

17. Security, PIN & Roles

- Roles: admin, cashier, timetable_manager, teacher, student, owner.
- Roles are stored in a separate user_roles table and enforced via Row-Level Security.
- Sensitive admin areas are gated by a 4-digit PIN.
- Idle sessions in admin areas are timed out automatically.
- All file uploads (receipts, photos, GRN evidence) are stored in private buckets and served via signed URLs.

18. Troubleshooting & Support

Cannot log in

- Check the registration number is exactly 6 characters.
- Confirm caps lock is off when typing the password.
- If 'account already claimed' appears unexpectedly, contact the administrator.

Receipt won't print

- Try downloading the PDF and printing from your browser's PDF viewer.
- For thermal printers, use the 80mm format.

Photo upload fails

- Use JPG or PNG under 5 MB.
- Check your internet connection and retry.

Need more help?

Contact the school's IT administrator. For urgent finance issues contact the Bursar's office during working hours.